

TODAY'S TOPIC: Phrasal Verbs in Business & Construction

(Focus: Professional communication, fluency in meetings, emails, and negotiations)

Phrasal verbs are **multi-word verbs** (verb + preposition/adverb) that native speakers use **all the time** in business. They make you sound natural and confident.

KEY PHRASAL VERBS FOR YOUR CONSTRUCTION BUSINESS

Phrasal Verb	Meaning	Example (Construction Context)
set up	establish / install	<i>We need to set up the scaffolding before pouring concrete.</i>
carry out	perform / execute	<i>The team will carry out safety inspections tomorrow.</i>
draw up	prepare (a plan/contract)	<i>Our architect is drawing up the new blueprints.</i>
hold up	delay	<i>Bad weather held up the foundation work by two days.</i>
take on	hire / accept (a project)	<i>We're planning to take on three new engineers next month.</i>
run into	encounter (a problem)	<i>We ran into some issues with the soil stability.</i>
speed up	make faster	<i>Can we speed up the delivery of steel beams?</i>
break down	fail / stop working / analyze	<i>The crane broke down again. OR Let's break down the budget.</i>

PRONUNCIATION & STRESS TIP

Phrasal verbs are **stressed on the particle** (the preposition/adverb), not the verb. Correct: *We need to **set UP** the site.* Wrong: *We **SET** up the site.*

Practice saying aloud:

- draw **UP**
- hold **UP**
- take **ON**
- run **INTO**

CULTURAL & BUSINESS INSIGHT

In **British English** (common in UAE, UK, India projects): → Use “**carry out**” more formally: *We carried out a risk assessment.*

In **American English** (common in US, Canada, KSA projects): → Use “**perform**” or “**do**”: *We performed a risk assessment.*

Your fluency goal: Switch naturally depending on your client!

EXERCISE 1: Fill in the Gaps

Use the correct phrasal verb from the table.

1. The client wants us to _____ a new contract by Friday.
2. Rain _____ the roofing schedule last week.
3. We're going to _____ two more workers for the night shift.
4. The machine _____ during the concrete pour — big problem!
5. Let's _____ the timeline so we finish early.

EXERCISE 2: Rewrite Professionally

Change the informal sentence into professional English using a phrasal verb.

1. *We made the plan yesterday.*
→ _____
2. *The truck had problems on the way.*
→ _____
3. *We need to make the process faster.*
→ _____

SPEAKING PRACTICE (Record Yourself!)

Answer **out loud** (record on phone):

**“Tell me about a time a project was delayed. What happened?
How did you fix it?”**

Use **at least 3 phrasal verbs** from today. Example start: *“Last month, bad weather **held up** the excavation, and we **ran into** groundwater issues...”*

HOMEWORK (Due Tomorrow)

1. **Write a short email (5–7 sentences)** to a client: - Apologize for a delay - Explain the problem - Say how you'll fix it - Use **4 phrasal verbs** from today
Subject: Update on Al Maktoum Project
2. **Record a 1-minute voice note** answering the speaking question above. Send it to me (or practice and replay).
3. **Learn 3 new phrasal verbs** from your work emails/messages today. Write them + 1 example each.

FLUENCY TIP OF THE DAY

Use **phrasal verbs in meetings** → You sound like a native boss. Instead of: “*We will install the system.*” Say: “*We’ll **set up** the system by Friday.*”

You’re building English fluency — just like your skyscrapers: **strong, fast, and impressive.**
— Ahsan

ANSWERS (Check after doing exercises):

Exercise 1:

1. draw up
2. held up
3. take on
4. broke down
5. speed up

Exercise 2:

1. We **drew up** the plan yesterday.
2. The truck **ran into** problems on the way.
3. We need to **speed up** the process.